strategically across two key targets: populist leaders and the domestic populations that empower them. By using these strategies, IOs can neutralize opposition, foster cooperation, and adapt to evolving political landscapes.

We conceptualize IOs' defensive tactics within a framework of four strategies: sidelining or appeasing populist leaders, and sidelining or appeasing their constituents (see table 1.1). These approaches are often employed simultaneously, comprising a multifaceted response to populist challenges.

When IOs sideline populist leaders, they minimize reliance on such leaders' cooperation and proceed with reduced participation. This strategy often involves sanctions, suspensions, or other penalties to punish noncompliance and deter similar behavior from others. IOs can also strengthen their independence by developing in-house expertise or focusing on areas where they are less reliant on populist states. Further, by building self-sufficiency or fostering partnerships with nonpopulist states, NGOs, or other IOs, they mitigate the impact of populist disengagement. For example, after the first Trump administration withheld energy-related data from the World Bank, the organization turned to Arab multilateral development banks for information, bypassing the United States entirely—an example we return to in chapter 4.

TABLE 1.1. IOs' defensive toolkit

	Sideline	**Appease**
Populists	Reduce reliance on populists; improve capacity; cooperate with other IOs, states, NGOs	Make policy concessions; reform to benefit populists (e.g., increase vote share)
Constituents	Engage populists covertly; empower nonpopulist actors	Cue the public; employ populist language

Appeasing populist leaders involves concessions to these leaders, such as offering favorable terms, material benefits, or reforms that address their grievances. For instance, international financial institutions like the World